

## Setting the countdown

In the next stage of building Countdown Calendar you'll create a function to count the number of days between today and your important events. You'll also write the code to display the events on the Tkinter canvas.



The function is given two dates.

### 14 Count the days

Create a function to count the number of days between two dates. The `datetime` module makes this easy, as it can add dates together or subtract one from another. Type the code shown here below your `get_events()` function. It will store the number of days as a string in the variable `time_between`.

```
def days_between_dates(date1, date2):
    time_between = str(date1 - date2)
```

This variable stores the result as a string.

The dates are subtracted to give the number of days between them.

### 15 Split the string

If Halloween is 27 days away, the string stored in `time_between` would look like this: `'27 days , 0:00:00'` (the zeros refer to hours, minutes, and seconds). Only the number at the beginning of the string is important, so you can use the `split()` command again to get to the part you need. Type the code highlighted below after the code in Step 14. It turns the string into a list of three items: `'27'`, `'days'`, `'0:00:00'`. The list is stored in `number_of_days`.



```
def days_between_dates(date1, date2):
    time_between = str(date1 - date2)
    number_of_days = time_between.split(' ')
```

This time the string is split at each blank space.

### 16 Return the number of days

To finish off this function, you just need to return the value stored in position 0 of the list. In the case of Halloween, that's 27. Add this line of code to the end of the function.

```
def days_between_dates(date1, date2):
    time_between = str(date1 - date2)
    number_of_days = time_between.split(' ')
    return number_of_days[0]
```

The number of days between the dates is held at position 0 in the list.